



says Sneha Poddar, VP, Research, Wealth Management at Motilal Oswal Financial Services. Also, healthcare companies, which are witnessing a rise in order flows, especially for contract development and manufacturing organisations (CDMOs), given the need to diversify from Chinese suppliers. Additionally, recent rate cuts will likely boost funding for clinical development projects and housing finance companies, strengthening their outlook, says Poddar.

### STRONG PIPELINE

According to a survey of economists by *Bloomberg*, India stands out as the only major economy with zero probability of slipping into recession, given the current economic landscape. This high

growth potential of the Indian economy is generating ample opportunities across all sectors, enabling both small and mid-sized companies to expand rapidly, says Bahl of Anand Rathi Advisors.

Narinder Wadhwa, Managing Director of broking firm SKI Capital, says, "The primary market is projected to stay robust, fuelled by sectors such as technology, renewable energy, and financial services. With a strong focus on ESG (environmental, social, and governance) initiatives, companies that align with India's digital transformation and sustainability goals are expected to attract investor interest." Though global economic factors could pose challenges, he says, India's primary market remains a preferred destination for both domestic and

international investors. "Sectors like IT services, consumer goods, and EV manufacturing continue to attract investment, bolstering India's market reputation as a global growth hub," Wadhwa adds.

The past five years have seen a remarkable transformation in the primary market, with wider participation across multiple sectors and from smaller companies. The number of new-age and e-commerce platforms listed on the bourses has grown to 29 in calendar year 2024 from just five in 2014, signifying a healthy business environment for start-ups in India.

The start-up ecosystem should provide a steady supply of companies looking to go public, thereby helping India's investible universe to expand. In addition, liquidity in the Indian market has increased materially over the last three-four years, which has provided big support to the primary market, especially the large issues, says Poddar of Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

Going ahead, there is a strong pipeline of 31 companies that have received approval from markets regulator, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi). They are estimated to raise a total of ₹45,000 crore in the coming year. The biggest among them is NTPC Green Energy, which is expected to raise ₹10,000 crore from its public offer, as per PRIME Database. Besides, there are another 56 companies that are waiting for Sebi's approval. These are estimated to raise around ₹90,000 crore in total from their IPOs.

How many of these firms eventually end up hitting the market will depend on how quickly the stock market is able to shake off its November jitters. **BT**

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